JAMES CAMERON REID

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff Engineer with seven years of hands-on experience building and scaling distributed systems across fintech and cloud infrastructure. I've led technical decisions that directly impacted product reliability for teams ranging from 5 to 30+ engineers. I'm particularly focused on mentoring mid-level engineers through complex architectural challenges and translating business requirements into robust, maintainable solutions. Outside of work, I'm keen on improving observability practices and contributing to open source standards in the infrastructure space.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

Meridian Systems Ltd

meridian-systems.io

London, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Architected and delivered a complete observability overhaul for our microservices platform, reducing mean time to detection by 65% and enabling the team to identify production incidents within minutes rather than hours

Led the technical design and implementation of our service mesh migration from Istio to Linkerd, working directly with platform and product teams to ensure zero downtime during the transition

Mentored four junior engineers through pair programming and code review, with two progressing to senior roles within eighteen months

Established coding standards and architectural review processes that reduced production incidents related to deployment errors by 48%

Senior Software Engineer

Nexus Financial Solutions

nexus-fin.co

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

June 2019 - February 2022

Designed and built the core payment processing engine handling over 2 million transactions daily across multiple currencies and compliance regions

Implemented comprehensive database sharding strategy that improved query performance by 72% and reduced infrastructure costs by approximately 35%

Worked cross-functionally with compliance and risk teams to ensure all systems met PCI-DSS requirements and FCA regulatory standards

Trained and onboarded seven new team members, establishing best practices for code quality and deployment procedures

Software Engineer

Velocity Data Services

velocity-data.net

Manchester, United Kingdom

September 2017 - May 2019

Developed high-performance data ingestion pipelines processing terabytes of customer analytics data in near real-time using Apache Kafka and Spark

Optimized legacy SQL queries and database indexes, reducing batch processing time from 8 hours to 45 minutes

Contributed to the design of our internal Python SDK that simplified integration work for frontend teams across three product lines

Participated in on-call rotations, responding to production incidents and implementing long-term fixes to prevent recurrence

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science

University of Edinburgh

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

Graduated June 2017

SKILLS

Technical: Go, Python, Java, SQL, PostgreSQL, Redis, Apache Kafka, Apache Spark, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, AWS (EC2, RDS, Lambda, S3), Google Cloud Platform, Grafana, Prometheus, Datadog, Linux system administration, CI/CD pipelines, gRPC, REST API design

Professional: System architecture, technical leadership, mentoring, performance optimization, incident management, code review, requirements analysis, agile methodologies, stakeholder communication